

Measure: Performance Conversations

Driving growth through meaningful dialogue

Why Performance Conversations Matter

This process closes out the performance cycle with a two-way, evidence-based conversation that aligns perspectives, celebrates results, and sets a forward-looking development plan.

Time for Reflection - Review accomplishments from the past year (individual and team). - Identify areas for improvement. - Understand what worked, what didn't, and how to apply learnings moving forward.	Feedback and Growth - Use reflection to identify skill gaps and development needs. - Encourage two-way feedback: leaders provide guidance; employees share perspectives. - Align on development goals, learning opportunities, and resources for the next cycle.	Celebration of Success - Acknowledge achievements, big or small. - Reinforce positive behaviors and boost morale. - Highlight impact—not just say “good job.”	Building Relationships - Strengthen trust through open, honest conversations. - Create a safe space where employees feel heard and valued. - Build a strong foundation for effective coaching, feedback, and development.
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Manager Checklist

Before	- Schedule 45–60 minutes and share the agenda in advance. - Ask for the teammate's self-evaluation and career aspirations. - Review your evaluation and calibration notes; pull concrete examples. - Identify key wins, growth areas, and potential development opportunities (training, mentorship, stretch work).
During	- Open with recognition; cite specific outcomes and impact. - Compare perspectives (self vs. manager) respectfully to find alignment. - Focus on behaviors and results—not personality. - Use structured feedback: STAR for praise; STAR-AR for coaching. - Listen actively, ask open questions, and check for understanding.
After	- Summarize agreements, decisions, and measures of success. - Document goals and a development plan (owner, milestone, date). - Send recap; schedule follow-ups (1:1s, mid-year check-in). - Complete UKG acknowledgements (employee then manager).

Feedback That Works

STAR	Situation / Task — context; Action — what was done; Result — impact. Use for clear, specific reinforcement.
STAR/AR	Add A lternative action and desired R esult to coach improvement; invite dialogue to uncover root causes and support needs.

Avoid These Pitfalls

Ineffective Feedback	- Vague or generalized feedback (e.g., ‘good job’). - Judgments about personality instead of observable behavior. - No actionable next steps or support. - Ignoring the employee's perspective and context.
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Sustain the Conversation

Growth and development happen over time, not just during a single annual conversation. Regular check-ins and ongoing dialogue are essential. You can use several tools and touchpoints to keep the momentum going

- Career Development Plans
- Talent Review
- Mid-year Check-Ins
- One on Ones (Formal or Informal)
- Skip Level Meetings
- Roundtable Sessions
- Employee Experience Survey Results.

Cycle Close-Out Reminders

- Release the review to the employee** so they can complete their final acknowledgement.
 - Wait for the employee to return the acknowledgement.**
 - Complete your manager acknowledgement** once the review is returned to you.
 - Finish all steps before the due date** to ensure you have time for a proper discussion and a smooth closeout of the process.
- IMPORTANT: If conversations and acknowledgements are not finalized by the deadline, ratings and comments will be automatically released and made available to the employee.***